

HTML And Beyond

Admit it. You want to have a personal Web site, don't you? Or perhaps you're running a small business, and you'd like to include a Web address on your visiting cards. And you don't know how to go about it beyond the basic HTML. This book is just what you're looking for! For those not familiar with basic HTML either, we've included a chapter on that subject.

There are several elements that go into a professional-looking Web site, and we have here tried to cover what you'd need to build one. After looking at the basics of HTML, we go into JavaScript and PHP—after all, you don't want any boring old static Web page, do you? We've also included material on site design tools such as FrontPage and Dreamweaver so you make a site with a minimum of fuss. FrontPage workshops have also been included.

Content Management Systems, which make it convenient to manage your Web site, have been discussed in some detail. If you'd like to put up a forum on your site—which in some cases is essential, and in some cases fun—we've explained how to do so, using easy-to-use tools.

After you've built your site, you need to upload it (don't forget that bit!) and also check for a few things—such as whether it is compatible with popular browsers and so on. A chapter is dedicated to uploading and testing your site. Finally, we present examples of well-made sites and what you can learn from them—and, complementarily, what Web design mistakes to avoid.

Web designing is a profession all by itself. So are JavaScript coding and PHP coding. And so also is the building of content management systems! We obviously cannot cover here all that you might need to know, but the enemy is inertia. The laziness that prevents you from getting started. This book is an introduction, a starting point. If you find Web site building is fun, you will look further and learn.

On the whole, by the time you've reached the end of this book, you should know what you need to get a basic site up and running—the site you've been promising yourself you'd build!